

Expense Tracker

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1 Introduction

Expense Tracker is a Python-based application developed to assist users in monitoring and managing their daily financial expenditures. Designed with simplicity and user-friendliness in mind, the application offers an intuitive interface that allows users to record their expenses, categorize them effectively, and obtain insightful summaries based on these categories. This tool aims to empower individuals to gain better control over their spending habits, facilitating improved budgeting and financial awareness.

2 Features Overview

The core functionalities of the Expense Tracker revolve around four major operations: adding expenses, managing categories, viewing expenses summaries, and displaying available categories. Each feature is crafted to ensure flexibility and customization for diverse user needs while maintaining ease of use.

2.1 Add Expense

Users can log new expenses by inputting essential information such as the date, amount, and associated category. The application stores this information systematically, enabling future retrieval and analysis. This feature promotes detailed record-keeping and helps users maintain accurate financial logs.

2.2 Add Category

To accommodate personalized tracking, users have the option to create new categories. By defining meaningful classifications, users can tailor the expense tracker to reflect their unique spending areas, such as groceries, entertainment, or transportation.

2.3 View Expenses

The application provides summarized views of total expenses grouped by categories. This analytical feature is instrumental in highlighting spending patterns, allowing users to identify areas where they may want to reduce or adjust their expenditures.

2.4 View Categories

Users can conveniently access a list of all existing categories within the system. This overview aids in managing and selecting the appropriate categories when logging expenses, ensuring consistency and clarity in financial records.

3 User Guide

This section details step-by-step instructions on how to utilize each major feature of the Expense Tracker, guiding users through the processes of recording and reviewing their expenses.

3.1 Adding an Expense

1. Select option **1** from the main menu.
2. Enter the date of the expense in the format YYYY-MM-DD.
3. Input the amount spent.
4. Specify the category under which this expense falls.

After these steps, the expense will be stored under the chosen category for future reference.

3.2 Adding a New Category

1. Select option **2** from the main menu.
2. Enter the desired name for the new category.

This new category will then be available for classification of future expenses.

3.3 Viewing Expenses Summary

1. Select option **3** from the main menu.
2. The application will display the total amount spent in each category.

This summary provides an immediate overview of spending distribution.

3.4 Viewing Categories

1. Select option 4 from the main menu.
2. The application will list all available categories.

This list helps users in selecting or managing categories effectively.

3.5 Exiting the Application

- Select option 5 to safely exit the Expense Tracker.

4 Technical Details

Expense Tracker is implemented purely in Python without reliance on external libraries, ensuring broad compatibility and straightforward deployment across different systems with Python installed.

4.1 System Requirements

- Python interpreter installed on the system (version 3.x recommended).
- Command line interface (Terminal or Command Prompt) for running the application.

4.2 Installation and Execution

1. Download the file `expense_tracker.py` from the project repository.
2. Open a terminal or command prompt and navigate to the directory containing the file.

3. Execute the program by entering the command:

`pythonexpense_tracker.py`

This procedure launches the Expense Tracker interface, ready for user interaction.

5 Summary Table of Features

Feature	Description	User Interaction Steps
Add Expense	Record new expenses with date, amount, and category.	Select menu option 1, input date, amount, and category.
Add Category	Create custom expense categories.	Select menu option 2, input new category name.
View Expenses	Display total expenses per category.	Select menu option 3, view categorized totals.
View Categories	List all available expense categories.	Select menu option 4, view categories list.
Exit	Quit the application safely.	Select menu option 5.

6 Conclusion

The Expense Tracker application stands as an efficient and accessible tool for personal finance management. By combining straightforward functionality with customizable options, it enables users to maintain detailed

expense records and gain actionable insights into their spending habits. Its dependency solely on the native Python environment ensures ease of setup and portability, making it a practical choice for users seeking a no-frills budgeting assistant.

```
37
38 if choice == "1":
39     date = input("Enter date (YYYY-MM-DD): ")
40     amount = float(input("Enter amount: $"))
41     category = input("Enter category: ")
42     tracker.add_expense(date, amount, category)
43 elif choice == "2":
44     category = input("Enter category: ")
45     tracker.add_category(category)
46 elif choice == "3":
47     tracker.view_expenses()
48 elif choice == "4":
49     tracker.view_categories()
50 elif choice == "5":
51     print("Exiting Expense Tracker. Goodbye!")
52     break
53 else:
54     print("Invalid choice. Please try again.")
55
```

PROBLEMS OUTPUT DEBUG CONSOLE TERMINAL PORTS Python +

```
2. Add Category
3. View Expenses
4. View Categories
5. Exit
Enter your choice: 1
Enter date (YYYY-MM-DD): 2023-06-07
Enter amount: $1500
Enter category: self

Expense Tracker Menu:
```

```
PROBLEMS OUTPUT DEBUG CONSOLE TERMINAL PORTS
```

```
5. Exit
Enter your choice: 1
Enter date (YYYY-MM-DD): 2023-06-07
Enter amount: $1500
Enter category: self

Expense Tracker Menu:
1. Add Expense
2. Add Category
3. View Expenses
4. View Categories
5. Exit
Enter your choice: █
```